



Identifying Essential Standards

PLC Question 1: What do we want students to learn?

Why this meeting matters

This is where teams begin shifting from coverage to guaranteed learning. Choosing one essential standard keeps the work manageable.

Meeting 5 · Wednesday, October 7, 2026 · 45 minutes	
Focus	What do we want students to learn?
Leave with	One selected essential standard.

Agenda — step by step

Time	What the team does
0–5 min	Review norms and roles. Confirm who holds each role today and re-read your team norms together. This is where the learning cycle begins — your team will pick one essential standard to guarantee. Pull up the standards for your course.
5–15 min	Teach vs. learn. Discuss the difference between what we teach and what students must learn.
15–35 min	Choose one essential standard. Review your standards and use REAL — readiness, endurance, assessed, leverage — to select just one.
35–43 min	Confirm it. Agree on the single essential standard for this cycle.
43–45 min	Assign pre-work. Bring the full text of your essential standard and your course's standards or curriculum materials for it — the raw material you'll break into learning targets next time.

Where we're going next → Meeting 6

Deconstructing the Essential Standard — Clarifying what students must know and be able to do.